

STUDIO RENACER

FREE GUIDE · PSYCHOEDUCATION

5 signs your anxiety *is* *work-related*

(and what to do about each one)

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If you've been running on empty, this is for you

If you don't know whether it's "normal work stress" or something more, this guide is for you.

Not to diagnose you —that's not done with a PDF— but so you can put a name to what's happening and have something concrete to do today.

Let me tell you one thing up front: work anxiety is almost never fixed with a trick. But recognising it in time changes everything. Let's go, no rush.

1 Sunday afternoon stops being yours

THE SIGN

By mid-afternoon on Sunday a knot appears in your stomach, irritability or a low mood. You're not sad about anything specific: your head is already in Monday.

WHY IT HAPPENS

It's anticipatory anxiety. Your nervous system "rehearses" the week in advance to protect you; when work is a source of sustained tension, it does so earlier and earlier.

WHAT TO DO TODAY

Spend 10 minutes getting everything you dread about Monday out of your head and onto paper (tasks, conversations, emails). Next to each, write only the first small step. It won't solve the week, but it lowers the volume: what's written stops spinning.

2 Your body complains before your head does

THE SIGN

Clenched jaw, tight neck and shoulders, sleep that doesn't rest, upset digestion, headaches, palpitations. At the check-up "all fine", but the body is tense.

WHY IT HAPPENS

Sustained anxiety lives in the body before the thoughts. When the source is work, it usually shows up first in the physical: it's easier to ignore a worry than a pain.

WHAT TO DO TODAY

Do the pattern test: do those symptoms appear on work days or hours and ease off at the weekend or on holiday? If yes, it's no coincidence. Note it for a week; that pattern is gold.

3 Switching off is hard, or makes you feel guilty

THE SIGN

You keep checking email after hours “just in case”. And when you finally stop, instead of resting, you feel guilty.

WHY IT HAPPENS

It's hypervigilance plus self-demand. If your worth is tightly tied to your performance, stopping is experienced as a threat, not a rest.

WHAT TO DO TODAY

Create a 3-minute end-of-day ritual: a phrase (“for today, that’s it”), close your tabs and a physical action that marks the end (turn off the computer, step outside, change clothes). You teach your brain where work ends.

4 On the outside you perform the same; inside you're at your limit

THE SIGN

You deliver, you cope, no one would say you're struggling. But inside you're driving with the handbrake on: it takes twice the effort and you fear it'll show.

WHY IT HAPPENS

It's high-performance anxiety. You compensate for the discomfort with more effort, so no one sees it... until the body says enough (sometimes as sick leave). Holding on is not the same as being well.

WHAT TO DO TODAY

Start measuring your energy, not just your tasks. At the end of the day, rate from 1 to 10 how empty you finished. Asking for help when the numbers drop isn't lowering your performance: it's exactly what protects it.

5

What used to fill you now leaves you cold (or everything irritates you)

THE SIGN

Things you used to enjoy say nothing to you now, or you snap at the slightest thing. You notice yourself more cynical or “disconnected” from work and from people.

WHY IT HAPPENS

These are signs of burnout, which isn't just tiredness: it's emotional exhaustion, distance and the feeling that nothing you do matters. The body shuts down what it can't sustain.

WHAT TO DO TODAY

Tell apart occasional tiredness from sustained burnout. Have you been like this for odd days or for weeks on end? If it's weeks, it's not “a bad patch”: it's a clear sign that it's time to stop and look at the root, not push harder.

AND NOW

Have you recognised yourself in two or more?

It's not weakness or "being soft". It's your body and mind warning you that this pace isn't sustainable — and that has a solution.

WHAT DOESN'T WORK

Holding on and waiting for it to pass on its own, or covering anxiety with a stray piece of advice.

WHAT DOES

Going to the root, at your pace, with real support. No rush and without giving up your career.

Want to take the first step?

Message me and we'll begin — no commitment.

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This guide is educational information; it is not a consultation or a diagnosis. If you're going through a hard time, talking to a professional helps. If you're in a crisis, call your local emergency number (112 in the EU) or a helpline (024 in Spain; Livslinien 70 201 201 in Denmark). · © 2026 Studio Renacer · Andrea Fernández, licensed psychologist reg. no. 27327.